

ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR DEFINED

Administrative behaviour refers to the actions, decisions, and interactions of individuals within an organization that are related to the management and operation of the organization. This includes how individuals in administrative roles handle tasks such as planning, organizing, coordinating, controlling, and decision-making. Administrative behaviour can also encompass how individuals communicate, collaborate, and handle conflicts within the organization. Understanding and analysing administrative behaviour can help improve organizational processes, effectiveness, and overall performance.

DEFINITION OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION.

Public administration refers to the implementation and management of policies, programs, and services by governmental agencies at various levels (local, state, and federal) to achieve the public interest and address public needs. Public administration involves activities such as planning, organizing, coordinating, directing, and controlling the resources and operations of government entities.

Public administrators are responsible for overseeing the day-to-day operations of government agencies, ensuring that programs and services are delivered efficiently and effectively, managing budgets and resources, and engaging with stakeholders and the public. They work to address issues such as public health, education, transportation, public safety, social services, and more, with a focus on promoting the common good and serving the needs of the community.

Studying public administration involves understanding the theories, principles, and practices of governance, public policy, management, and leadership in the public sector. It also involves examining the role of government in society, the relationship between government and citizens, and the ethical considerations involved in public service.

THE SCOPE OF ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR.

The scope of administrative behaviour is broad and encompasses various aspects of organizational management and leadership. Some key areas within the scope of administrative behaviour include:

1. Decision-Making: Administrative behaviour involves the study of how individuals in administrative roles make decisions within organizations. This

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includes the factors that influence decision-making, the decision-making processes, and the outcomes of decisions.

2. **Communication:** Effective communication is crucial in administrative behaviour as it impacts how information flows within the organization, how decisions are communicated, and how individuals collaborate and work together.

3. **Leadership:** Leadership is a crucial component of administrative behaviour, as leaders set the direction for the organization, inspire and motivate employees, and make important decisions that impact organizational performance.

4. **Organizational Culture:** Administrative behaviour also includes the study of organizational culture, which refers to the values, norms, and beliefs that shape the behaviour of individuals within the organization. Understanding and managing organizational culture is essential for effective administration.

5. **Conflict Management:** Administrative behaviour involves managing conflicts that may arise within the organization. This includes understanding the causes of conflicts, resolving disputes, and fostering a healthy work environment.

6. **Motivation and Reward Systems:** Administrative behaviour covers the ways in which organizations motivate and incentivize employees to perform at their best. This includes the design of reward systems, performance evaluations, and employee recognition programs.

7. **Ethics and Social Responsibility:** Administrative behaviour includes ethical considerations in decision-making, ensuring that organizational actions are aligned with ethical standards and social responsibility principles.

Overall, the scope of administrative behaviour is multidimensional and requires a deep understanding of organizational dynamics, human behaviour, and management principles to effectively lead and manage organizations.

of the key contributions of Herbert Simon to administrative behaviour include:

1. **Bounded Rationality:** Simon introduced the concept of bounded rationality, which suggests that individuals have limitations in their ability to process and analyse information and make decisions. He argued that decision-makers often rely on heuristics (rules of thumb) and satisficing (accepting satisfactory, rather than the optimal, solutions) due to these cognitive limitations. This concept revolutionized the understanding of decision-making processes in organizations.
2. **Administrative Decision-Making:** Simon's research on administrative decision-making focused on the decision-making processes in organizations. He emphasized the importance of understanding the cognitive limitations of decision-makers, the complexity of organizational environments, and the role of organizational structures in shaping decision-making processes.
3. **Organizational Design:** Simon's work highlighted the importance of organizational design in shaping administrative behaviour. He explored how organizational structures, hierarchies, and communication channels impact decision-making, coordination, and overall performance within organizations.
4. **Behavioural Economics:** Simon's research on administrative behaviour paved the way for the field of behavioural economics, which combines insights from psychology and economics to understand how individuals make decisions in complex environments. His work laid the foundation for studying human behaviour in the context of organizational settings.
5. **Problem Solving and Creativity:** Simon also studied problem-solving and creativity in administrative settings. He explored how individuals identify problems, generate alternative solutions, and make decisions under conditions of uncertainty and ambiguity. His work on creativity and innovation has influenced research on entrepreneurship and organizational change.

Overall, Herbert Simon's contributions to administrative behaviour have had a lasting impact on the fields of organizational behaviour, management, decision-making, and public administration. His pioneering work has shaped our understanding of how individuals behave in organizations and has informed practical strategies for improving organizational performance and effectiveness.

THE RATIONAL PRINCIPLES OF ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR.

The rational principles of administrative behaviour are based on the assumption

that individuals within organizations make decisions in a rational manner by weighing the costs and benefits of various options to arrive at the best possible course of action. Some key rational principles of administrative behaviour include

1. **Goal Orientation:** Administrators and managers are expected to act in a goal-oriented manner, aligning their actions with the overarching goals and objectives of the organization. This involves setting clear goals, prioritizing tasks, and making decisions that contribute to the achievement of organizational goals.
2. **Economic Rationality:** The rational principles of administrative behaviour suggest that individuals within organizations are rational actors who seek to maximize their self-interest and utility. This includes making decisions that are economically rational and cost-effective, considering the resources available and the potential outcomes.
3. **Optimization:** Rational administrative behaviour involves optimizing decision-making processes to achieve the best possible outcomes. This may involve analysing and comparing different options, selecting the most optimal solution, and allocating resources efficiently to accomplish organizational objectives.
4. **Information Processing:** Rational decision-making in administration requires individuals to gather and process relevant information to make informed choices. This involves conducting research, analysing data, seeking input from stakeholders, and considering various perspectives before making decisions.
5. **Systematic Approach:** Rational administrative behaviour emphasizes a systematic approach to problem-solving and decision-making. This involves breaking down complex issues into manageable components, identifying patterns and relationships, and developing logical strategies to address challenges and achieve goals.
6. **Adaptability:** Rational administrative behaviour also involves being adaptable and responsive to changes in the external environment. Administrators should be

able to adjust their strategies and tactics based on new information, emerging trends, and unexpected events to ensure organizational success.

While the rational principles of administrative behaviour provide a framework for decision-making and problem-solving in organizations, it is essential to recognize that real-world decision-making is often influenced by cognitive biases, emotional factors, political dynamics, and organizational constraints. By understanding both the rational principles and the limitations of administrative behaviour, administrators can make more effective decisions and achieve better outcomes for their organizations.

THE PURPOSIVE AND INTEGRATIVE BEHAVIOUR

"Purposive and integrative behaviour" refers to the intentional actions and coordinated efforts that individuals within organizations undertake to achieve specific goals and objectives. This concept encompasses two key aspects:

1. **Purposive Behaviour:** Purposive behaviour refers to the deliberate and goal-directed actions that individuals take to accomplish specific aims or objectives within an organization. This involves setting clear goals, identifying tasks and activities that need to be completed, and aligning individual and collective efforts towards achieving these goals. Purposive behaviour emphasizes intentionality, planning, and focus on the desired outcomes.

2. **Integrative Behaviour:** Integrative behaviour involves bringing together diverse perspectives, skills, and resources within an organization to work collaboratively towards common goals. This includes fostering teamwork, communication, and coordination among individuals and groups to integrate their efforts and leverage their strengths to achieve shared objectives. Integrative behaviour emphasizes the importance of collaboration, synergy, and mutual support in achieving organizational success.

In essence, purposive and integrative behaviour are interconnected aspects of organizational behaviour that work in tandem to drive performance and effectiveness. By engaging in purposive behaviour, individuals set clear goals and objectives, while integrative behaviour enables them to work together cohesively and harmoniously to achieve those goals. This combination of intentional action and collaboration is essential for organizations to successfully navigate complex

challenges, make informed decisions, and achieve sustainable outcomes. Emphasizing purposive and integrative behaviour can help organizations align their efforts, enhance productivity, and foster a culture of shared purpose and mutual support among employees.

THE EVOLUTION OF ADMINISTRATIVE THEORY

The evolution of administrative behaviour can be traced back to the early theories of management and organization that emerged in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Over time, various scholars and researchers have contributed to our understanding of administrative behaviour through their studies and theories. Here are some key milestones in the evolution of administrative behaviour:

- 1. Classical Management Theory:** The early theories of management, such as those proposed by Frederick Taylor (scientific management) and Henri Fayol (administrative management), focused on principles of efficiency, hierarchy, specialization, and authority within organizations. These theories laid the groundwork for understanding organizational structure and processes.
- 2. Human Relations Movement:** In the 1930s and 1940s, scholars like Elton Mayo and Kurt Lewin shifted the focus to the influence of social and psychological factors on administrative behaviour. They emphasized the importance of interpersonal relationships, motivation, and employee satisfaction in organizational performance.
- 3. Bureaucratic Theory:** Max Weber's theory of bureaucracy, developed in the early 20th century, highlighted the role of rules, regulations, and formal structures in administrative behaviour. Weber's ideas on rational-legal authority and division of labour influenced the way organizations are structured and managed.
- 4. Systems Theory:** In the mid-20th century, scholars like Ludwig von Bertalanffy and Kenneth Boulding introduced systems theory to management thinking. This approach views organizations as complex systems of interrelated parts, emphasizing the interconnectedness and interdependence of different elements in administrative behaviour.
- 5. Contingency Theory:** Beginning in the 1960s, contingency theorists like Joan Woodward and Paul Lawrence argued that administrative behaviour is contingent on various internal and external factors, such as technology, environment, and organizational goals. This approach emphasized the need for flexibility and

adaptability in organizational management.

6. Modern Approaches: Today, administrative behaviour is studied through a variety of lenses, including strategic management, organizational behaviour, leadership theory, and public administration. Researchers continue to explore the dynamics of administrative behaviour in organizations and the implications for performance, innovation, and sustainability.

Overall, the evolution of administrative behaviour reflects a shifting focus from efficiency and structure to human factors, systems thinking, and contextual influences in understanding and managing organizations. It demonstrates the ongoing development and refinement of theories and practices to address the complexities of administrative behaviour in modern organizations.

THE IMPORTANCE OF DECISION MAKING TO ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR

Decision-making is a crucial aspect of administrative behaviour and plays a significant role in shaping the effectiveness, efficiency, and overall performance of organizations. Some of the key importance of decision-making to administrative behaviour include:

1. **Setting Direction:** Decision-making helps administrators set the direction and priorities for the organization. By making strategic decisions about goals, objectives, and resource allocation, administrators provide a clear sense of purpose and direction for employees to follow.
2. **Problem-Solving:** Decision-making is essential for identifying and addressing problems and challenges within the organization. Administrators use decision-making processes to analyse issues, develop solutions, and implement action plans to overcome obstacles and improve organizational performance.
3. **Resource Allocation:** Decision-making involves allocating resources such as budget, manpower, and time effectively and efficiently. By making informed decisions about resource allocation, administrators can optimize the use of resources to achieve organizational goals.
4. **Risk Management:** Decision-making plays a role in managing risks and uncertainties within the organization. Administrators assess potential risks, evaluate alternatives, and make decisions that minimize risks while maximizing opportunities for success.

5. **Adaptability:** Effective decision-making enables organizations to be adaptable and responsive to changes in the external environment. Administrators make decisions that enable the organization to pivot, innovate, and evolve in response to new challenges, trends, and opportunities.

6. **Performance Evaluation:** Decision-making provides a basis for evaluating organizational performance and progress toward goals. By monitoring and analysing the outcomes of decisions, administrators can assess the effectiveness of strategies, make adjustments as needed, and drive continuous improvement.

7. **Stakeholder Engagement:** Decision-making involves engaging with stakeholders such as employees, customers, suppliers, and the community. Administrators make decisions that take into account the interests and needs of various stakeholders, building trust, collaboration, and support for organizational initiatives.

Overall, decision-making is a fundamental aspect of administrative behaviour that influences the direction, operations, and outcomes of organizations. By making informed, strategic, and timely decisions, administrators can guide and lead their organizations effectively, navigate challenges, and achieve sustainable success.

THE MODEL APPROACH TO ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR

The model approach to administrative behaviour is a framework that seeks to understand and explain how individuals behave in administrative roles within organizations. This approach emphasizes the systematic study of behaviours, interactions, and decision-making processes in the context of management and administration. The model approach outlines several key components to analyse and interpret administrative behaviour

1. **Rationality:** The model approach assumes that individuals in administrative roles are rational decision-makers who seek to maximize their self-interest or the interests of the organization. Rationality involves making decisions that are based on a logical assessment of available information, goals, and alternatives.

2. **Goals and Objectives:** Individuals in administrative roles are motivated by certain goals and objectives, which guide their behaviour and decision-making processes. These goals can be related to personal career advancement, organizational success, financial rewards, or other incentives.
3. **Information Processing:** Administrative behaviour involves the processing and interpretation of information to make decisions and take actions. This includes gathering relevant data, analysing it, and using it to inform decision-making processes.
4. **Decision-making Models:** The model approach examines various decision-making models that individuals in administrative roles may use, such as rational decision-making, bounded rationality, satisficing, or intuition. These models help explain how individuals make choices under conditions of uncertainty and limited information.
5. **Organizational Context:** Administrative behaviour is influenced by the organizational context, including factors such as structure, culture, leadership, communication, power dynamics, and external environments. These organizational factors shape how individuals behave and interact within the organization.
6. **Feedback and Evaluation:** The model approach considers how feedback mechanisms and performance evaluation processes impact administrative behaviour. Feedback helps individuals assess their performance, adjust their behaviour, and make improvements in their roles.

Overall, the model approach to administrative behaviour provides a framework for studying and analysing how individuals in administrative roles think, act, and make decisions within organizations. By understanding these dynamics, organizations can develop strategies to enhance performance, improve communication, and achieve their goals effectively.

DIFFERENT MODELS OF ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR

There are several different models of administrative behaviour.

proposed by scholars and researchers to help analyse and understand how individuals behave in administrative roles within organizations. Some of the key models of administrative behaviour include:

1. **Rational Model:** The rational model of administrative behaviour assumes that individuals make decisions in a logical and rational manner by weighing all available information, evaluating alternatives, and choosing the best course of action to achieve their goals. This model emphasizes the importance of systematic decision-making processes.
2. **Bounded Rationality Model:** The bounded rationality model recognizes that individuals have cognitive limitations and are unable to process and consider all available information when making decisions. Instead, individuals use shortcuts, heuristics, and satisficing strategies to make decisions that are satisfactory but not necessarily optimal.
3. **Administrative Management Model:** The administrative management model, often associated with Henri Fayol, focuses on the principles of planning, organizing, coordinating, commanding, and controlling within organizations. This model emphasizes the importance of hierarchical structures, formal authority, and clear roles and responsibilities in administrative behaviour.
4. **Systems Model:** The systems model of administrative behaviour views organizations as complex systems of interrelated parts that interact with each other and with the external environment. This model highlights the interconnectedness and interdependence of different elements within organizations and how changes or actions in one part of the system can affect the entire organization.
5. **Contingency Model:** The contingency model of administrative behaviour recognizes that there is no one-size-fits-all approach to management and that organizational practices must be tailored to fit the specific circumstances and context of the organization. This model emphasizes flexibility, adaptability, and responsiveness to environmental factors.

6. **Political Model:** The political model of administrative behaviour focuses on the power dynamics, conflicts, and negotiations that shape decision-making processes within organizations. This model highlights the influence of stakeholder processes groups, and internal politics on administrative behaviour and outcomes.

7. **Behavioural Model:** The behavioural model of administrative behaviour draws on insights from psychology and sociology to understand how individuals' attitudes, beliefs, motivations, and emotions influence their behaviour within organizations. This model examines factors such as personality, leadership style, communication, and group dynamics.

These models provide different perspectives and frameworks for analysing administrative behaviour and can help researchers and practitioners understand and improve decision-making, leadership, and organizational effectiveness within diverse organizational settings.

THE RATIONAL APPROACH TO ADMINISTRATIVE BEHAVIOUR.

The rational approach to administrative behaviour is based on the assumption that individuals within organizations make decisions in a systematic and logical manner, aiming to achieve the best possible outcomes. This approach emphasizes the following key principles:

1. **Rationality:** The rational approach assumes that individuals act rationally by gathering relevant information, evaluating options based on clear goals and objectives, and selecting the option that maximizes their utility or the organization's interests.

2. **Goal-Oriented:** Administrators are seen as goal-oriented individuals who seek to achieve specific objectives and outcomes. They identify the organization's goals, assess the available resources and constraints, and make decisions that align with these goals.

3. **Decision-Making Process:** The rational approach focuses on the decision-making process, which involves defining the problem, generating alternatives, evaluating

4. **Information Processing:** Administrators are expected to process information systematically and objectively. They gather data, analyse trends, consider various factors and scenarios, and use this information to make informed decisions.
5. **Optimizing Behaviour:** The rational approach assumes that individuals engage in optimizing behaviour, seeking to maximize benefits or outcomes while minimizing costs and risks. Decision-makers aim to identify the best possible solution among available alternatives.
6. **Consideration of Consequences:** Administrators using the rational approach consider the consequences and implications of their decisions. They weigh the potential risks, benefits, and long-term implications of different options before making a choice.
7. **Transparency and Consistency:** Rational decision-making in administrative behaviour is transparent and consistent. Administrators make decisions based on objective criteria, facts, and analysis, rather than personal biases or emotions.
8. **Continuous Improvement:** The rational approach supports the idea of continuous improvement and learning from past decisions. Administrators reflect on the outcomes of their decisions, adjust their strategies based on feedback, and strive for better results in future decision-making processes.

Overall, the rational approach to administrative behaviour offers a structured and logical framework for analysing and understanding how individuals within organizations make decisions to achieve organizational goals and objectives. While the rational approach provides a systematic way to approach decision-making, it is important to recognize that real-world decision-making processes may also involve cognitive limitations, emotional factors, and complexities that cannot always be fully captured by a purely rational model.

SOLUTIONS

ADMINISTRATIVE FAILURE IN AN ORGANISATION.

Addressing administrative failures in an organization requires a comprehensive approach that identifies root causes, implements corrective measures, and fosters a culture of continuous improvement. Some potential solutions to address administrative failure in an organization include:

1. **Improve Communication:** Enhance communication channels within the organization to ensure that information flows freely, transparently, and effectively among employees, departments, and management levels. Encourage open dialogue, active listening, and feedback mechanisms to promote clarity and collaboration.
2. **Strengthen Leadership:** Invest in leadership development programs to nurture strong and effective leaders within the organization. Provide training, coaching, and mentorship to leaders to enhance their decision-making skills, communication abilities, and ability to inspire and motivate others.
3. **Strategic Planning:** Develop clear, actionable, and well-defined strategic plans that outline organizational goals, objectives, priorities, and strategies for achieving success. Ensure that planning processes involve input from key stakeholders and are aligned with the organization's mission and vision.
4. **Allocate Resources Wisely:** Ensure that resources, including financial, human, technological, and infrastructural resources, are allocated optimally to support administrative functions. Conduct regular resource assessments, identify gaps, and prioritize investments in areas that will drive organizational performance.
5. **Foster a Positive Organizational Culture:** Build a supportive and inclusive organizational culture that values transparency, integrity, teamwork, and excellence. Promote ethical behaviour, mutual respect, and a commitment to continuous learning and improvement.

6. **Embrace Change:** Encourage a culture that is agile, adaptable, and responsive to change. Embrace innovation, creativity, and continuous improvement to stay ahead of industry trends, market shifts, and technological advancements.

4. **Information Processing:** Administrators are expected to process information.
7. **Invest in Training and Development:** Provide employees with opportunities for ongoing training, skill development, and career advancement. Equip staff with the tools, knowledge, and resources they need to excel in their roles and contribute to organizational success.
8. **Improve Decision-Making Processes:** Implement structured decision-making processes that involve critical thinking, data analysis, stakeholder engagement, and risk assessment. Encourage a collaborative approach to decision-making that leverages diverse perspectives and expertise.
9. **Monitor and Evaluate Performance:** Establish key performance indicators (KPIs) and metrics to track progress, measure success, and identify areas for improvement. Conduct regular performance evaluations, reviews, and audits to assess the impact of administrative actions and initiatives.

By implementing these solutions and fostering a culture of accountability, transparency, and continuous improvement, organizations can address administrative failures, enhance operational efficiency, and drive sustainable success. Regularly reviewing and adjusting strategies in response to challenges and opportunities will help organizations navigate complexity and thrive in a dynamic business environment.

NOT FOR SALE